



AI Playbook and Toolkit for Public Health Departments

AI for Training Facilitation and Learner Feedback

HED 140

This module prepares trainers and health educators to use AI to support training facilitation, learner practice, formative feedback, and curriculum improvement. It emphasizes that AI feedback should support learning and revision, not replace instructors, supervisors, or official competency decisions. The module also addresses privacy, bias, accessibility, and approved-tool awareness when learner submissions or training records are involved.

Level	applied
Primary track	Health Education Track
Appears in tracks	health-education

Learning Objectives

- Explain appropriate and inappropriate uses of AI in training facilitation and learner feedback.
- Design a formative feedback workflow that protects learner privacy and avoids sensitive data exposure.
- Use rubrics to guide AI-assisted feedback on practice activities.
- Develop a plan for instructor or supervisor review of AI-supported learner feedback.

Module Overview

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Jurisdiction and Agency Policy Note

This national-level training module is intended for public health education, planning, and workforce development. It does not replace agency policy, legal review, privacy review, security review, procurement review, communications clearance, civil rights review, Tribal consultation, or governance approval. Learners should confirm applicable requirements, approved tools, data rules, and review pathways within their own jurisdiction and organization before implementing AI-supported workflows.

Why This Topic Matters for Public Health AI

Training programs increasingly use AI to create scenarios, generate practice questions, summarize discussion themes, and provide formative feedback. These uses can improve access to practice and help learners revise their work, but they can also create privacy, fairness, and trust concerns. Learners may paste real work products, sensitive program details, or personal reflections into an AI tool without realizing how the information is handled. Trainers need workflows that make AI support useful while protecting learners and ensuring that humans remain accountable for learning decisions.

Formative feedback is different from official grading or certification. AI can identify strengths, missing elements, unclear assumptions, and possible revisions, but it should not be framed as final approval of competency. This distinction matters in public health because exercises may involve governance, privacy, legal, equity, communications, or technical issues that require human review. Training programs should make clear what the AI can do, what it cannot do, and when learners should seek instructor or supervisor input.

Public Health Example

A public health training team develops an AI-supported practice exercise for use case intake. Learners complete a fictional intake worksheet, then use an approved AI feedback prompt to check whether they described the public health problem, data, affected populations, risks, reviewers, and next steps. The prompt warns learners not to include real PHI, confidential agency information, or non-public operational details. The trainer reviews the AI feedback pattern after the session and updates the exercise instructions because many learners missed the same human review requirement.

Technical, Programmatic, and Operational Deep Dive

AI can support training design by generating scenario variations, draft knowledge-check questions, discussion prompts, and role-play materials. Trainers should review all AI-generated training content for accuracy, fairness, accessibility, and alignment with learning objectives. AI can also help adapt practice cases for different roles, such as

program staff, communications staff, epidemiologists, IT staff, or governance committee members. However, scenarios should be fictional, generalized, or properly de-identified unless the tool and data use are approved.

AI-assisted learner feedback should be guided by module-specific rubrics. A rubric tells the AI and the learner what quality means for a specific exercise. For example, a use case intake exercise might evaluate problem definition, workflow clarity, data sensitivity, affected populations, governance pathway, and safeguards. The feedback should return strengths, gaps, suggested revisions, and questions for human review rather than a pass/fail decision.

Training teams should decide whether learner submissions will be stored, who can see feedback, and whether AI feedback counts toward completion. In many settings, the safest first step is a copy-prompt workflow where learners use fictional content and paste the prompt into an agency-approved AI tool. If the website later accepts uploads or stores feedback, privacy, security, and records rules become more important. Trainers should document these choices before launching AI-supported feedback.

Risks, Failure Modes, and Guardrails

A key risk is that learners may disclose sensitive information in examples or submissions. They may include real cases, partner names, staff concerns, security details, or program data because they want realistic feedback. Guardrails include explicit no-sensitive-data warnings, fictional case examples, confirmation checkboxes, and approved-tool requirements. Trainers should model safe examples and explain why realistic does not mean identifiable.

Another failure mode is treating AI feedback as objective or final. AI feedback may miss important context, overemphasize superficial writing quality, or fail to recognize local policy requirements. The training design should label AI feedback as formative and advisory. For exercises that affect real work, the final review should remain with instructors, supervisors, governance bodies, or designated reviewers.

A third risk is uneven learner experience. Some learners may receive more useful feedback because they write clearer submissions or know how to prompt AI, while others may receive vague or misleading feedback. Rubrics, sample submissions, prompt templates, and instructor debriefs can reduce this inequity. The training team should monitor feedback quality and revise prompts when needed.

Application to AI-Supported Workflows

This module applies when AI supports workshops, self-paced courses, field exercises, tabletop exercises, onboarding, or role-based learning plans. The workflow should define the exercise, rubric, learner warning, feedback format, human review step, and storage policy. AI-generated feedback should help learners improve artifacts such as worksheets, scripts, review memos, and implementation plans. It should not approve real projects or replace human accountability.

Reflection Questions

What kinds of learner submissions could contain sensitive information?

Which exercises in your training program could benefit from rubric-guided formative feedback?

How should instructors explain the difference between AI feedback and final review?

Practical Exercise

Design an AI formative feedback workflow for one practical exercise in this curriculum. Include the learner warning, approved-tool requirement, rubric criteria, feedback sections, human review step, and whether feedback will be saved.

Example: For a communications exercise, the workflow might require learners to use a fictional public health advisory, confirm they are not submitting sensitive data, request feedback on accuracy, plain language, accessibility, equity, and tone, then discuss the feedback with a trainer before revising the message.

Expected Artifact or Evidence

AI formative feedback workflow for one training exercise.

Rubric with 5 to 8 criteria.

Learner-facing safety warning and human review note.

Knowledge Check

- 1. What is the purpose of formative feedback?
- 2. What should learners avoid submitting to AI feedback tools?
- 3. Why are rubrics important for AI-assisted feedback?
- 4. What should AI feedback include?
- 5. When should human review remain part of the workflow?

References and Resources

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